Assignment Brief
Understanding Business
Academic Year 2026

Unit Information:	
Qualification:	**Foundation Diploma in Business / CS & IT (SCQF Level 6 – Equivalent to A Level)**
Unit Code & Title:	**J229 76** **Understanding Business**
Assignment Title:	**Assignment 1** LO1 - Task A: Report (Individual) LO2 - Task B: Report (Individual) Total Marks: 100
Results Reporting	Assignment 1: Task A: 50% Assignment 1: Task B: 50%

Date of Issue: 15-01-2026	**Due Date:** 15-02-2026

<u>To be Filled by the Student</u>

Student USN:

College Name & Site: JAIN College

Tutor:

Date Due:

Date of Submission:

*All work must be submitted on or before the due date. If an extension of time to submit work is required, a Mitigating Circumstance Form must be submitted.

Has an extension been approved? ☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

If yes, please provide the new submission date ……/….. /……., and affix appropriate evidence.

First Marker:	**Second Marker:**
Agreed Mark:	**Refer: Yes / No**

General Guidelines for Assessment

1. Attach a title page to your assignment. Use the previous page as your cover sheet and ensure that you fill in the details correctly.
2. All assignment work should be prepared using word processing software and should be organized and clearly structured

Word Processing Guidance

1. Use a font type that makes it easy for your examiner to read, for example, Arial or Times New Roman.
2. Use 1.5-line line spacing. Left-justify all paragraphs.
3. Ensure that all headings are consistent in terms of size and font style.
4. Use the footer function to insert your Student ID, Name, Subject, Module code, and Page Number on each page.
5. Use the spell check and grammar check functions to check your assignment.

Assignment Submission

1. Ensure that you give yourself enough time to complete the assignment by the due date. You must take responsibility for managing your own time effectively.
2. Submit an electronic version uploaded to the student learning management system on or before the stated deadline.
3. Submissions received up to 72 hours after the deadline will be penalized in line with JAIN College's Late Submission Policy. Thereafter, submissions will not be accepted.
4. If you are unable to hand in your assignment on time and have valid reasons, such as illness, you may apply (in writing) for an extension under the terms of the JAIN COLLEGE Mitigating Circumstances Policy.
5. Non-submission of work without a valid reason will lead to an automatic REFERRAL. You will then be asked to complete an alternative assignment. Your work will be capped at a PASS.

Declaration of Authenticity

6. Exercise meticulous care when incorporating the work or ideas of others into your assignment. Ensure that all sources are accurately acknowledged using the Harvard referencing system, both within the text and in the bibliography. Failure to provide proper attribution may result in an investigation and potential penalties for plagiarism, in accordance with the JAIN College Malpractice Policy

Statement of Originality and Student Declaration

I hereby, declare that I know what plagiarism entails, namely to use another's work and to present it as my own without attributing the sources in the correct way. I further acknowledge that I am aware of what constitutes copying or using another's work without appropriate acknowledgement.

1. I know that plagiarism is a punishable offence because it constitutes theft and the consequences of plagiarism as outlined in the Malpractice Policy.
2. I understand JAIN College's plagiarism, ghost writing and copying policy.
3. I declare that all work presented by me for every aspect of this assignment is my own, and where I have made use of another's work, I have rightly attributed the source.
4. I acknowledge that the attachment of this document, signed or not, constitutes my agreement to the above.
5. I understand that my assignment will not be considered as submitted if this declaration is not included.

Student's Signature: …… **Date: ……**

Assignment 1: Report on Understanding Business

This assessment evaluates Learning Outcomes through one summative task.

Task A – Summative Assessment

After the discussion, you are required to submit an individual report. Your report should cover the following points:

LO1: Analyse the features, objectives and internal structures of large organisations by:

1.1 *Comparing features of large organisations from different sectors of the economy*

- **Task 1.1.1**: Using the organisational examples Tata Motors (secondary sector), NHS Scotland (tertiary sector), and Oxfam (third sector), compare their features in terms of:
  a) Scale and resources,
  b) Formal structure and hierarchy,
  c) Specialisation and division of labour,
  d) Regulatory requirements, and
  e) Access to capital. (8 Marks)

- **Task 1.1.2:** Compare the structural characteristics of:
  a) A Private Limited Company,
  b) A Public Limited Company, and
  c) A Franchise. (6 Marks)

- **Task 1.1.3:** Using examples like the bakery increasing production capacity, Infosys expanding through technology investment, the Tata Motors–Jaguar Land Rover acquisition, and the Starbucks–Tata partnership, compare internal (organic) growth with external (inorganic) growth. Explain why each method was chosen with reference to access to technology, speed of expansion, new market entry, investment requirements, and risk considerations. (6 Marks)

1.2 *Identifying the objectives of large organisations and describing the importance of these objectives*

- **Task 1.2.1:** Using the organisational examples Reliance Jio, Tata Group, Amul, and Unilever, identify the objectives each organisation pursued and explain the importance of these objectives at the time they were adopted. (15 Marks)

1.3 *Describing internal structures large organisations may use, justifying why they would use these structures*

- **Task 1.3.1:** Describe the hierarchical, functional, and matrix organisational structures and justify why large organisations such as NHS Scotland, Tata Motors, Infosys/TCS, and NASA adopt these structures. (10 Marks)

- **Task 1.3.2:** Explain how large organisations make strategic, tactical, and operational decisions, and describe why they use tools such as SWOT analysis and decision trees. (5 Marks)

<u>Task B – Summative Assessment</u>

LO2: Analyse the environment in which large organisations operate by:

2.1 *Explaining the impact of internal factors on a large organisation*

- **Task 2.1:** Analyse how internal factors influence the performance and decision-making of large organisations.
  Explain the roles of staffing, finance, technology, and corporate culture, and critically examine how internal strengths and weaknesses may support or constrain organisational objectives. Include a comparative analysis of the following examples:
  - Toyota focuses on lean culture, continuous improvement, and workforce involvement
  - Boeing is focusing on structural, cultural, and management issues affecting performance

  (15 Marks)

  Provide an explanation based on the following criteria:
  a. How internal culture shapes behaviour and quality,
  b. How internal weaknesses create operational risk,
  c. Why internal alignment is critical for long-term organisational success.

2.2 *Explaining the impact of external factors on a large organisation*

- **Task 2.2:** Evaluate how external environmental factors affect large organisations operating in competitive and global markets.
  Using the PESTEC framework, explain how political, economic, social, technological, environmental, competitive, and ethical factors influence organisational strategy and adaptability. (20 Marks)

The response must include:

a. An analysis of Netflix, focusing on technological change and shifting social behaviour, and
b. An analysis of McDonald's, focusing on globalisation, cultural adaptation, and ethical considerations.

Provide an explanation based on the following criteria:

a. How organisations respond differently to external pressures,
b. Why is adaptability essential in dynamic environments?
c. How global organisations balance standardisation with local responsiveness.

2.3 *Describing conflicts of interest that could exist between stakeholders*

- **Task 2.3**: Describe the types of stakeholders involved in large organisations and analyse how conflicts of interest can arise between them.
  Explain the concept of stakeholder interdependence and why managing stakeholder relationships is critical for organisational sustainability. (15 Marks)

  The response must include:

  a) A detailed discussion of stakeholder groups such as owners, managers, employees, customers, suppliers, government, and the wider community, and
  b) A case-based analysis of conflict between employee welfare and shareholder expectations, such as seen in large logistics or warehouse-based organisations.

  Provide a demonstration and explanation based on the following criteria:

  a) How organisations attempt to balance competing stakeholder demands,
  b) How unresolved conflicts can damage reputation and performance,
  c) Why integrated environmental analysis is important for long-term decision-making.

Note:

- All learners are required to mandatorily participate in both Task A and B of Assignment 1 (Summative Task).
- The assignment will be assessed based on the single report submitted for both Task A and B of Assignment 1 (Summative Task).
- Your reports should cover all the learning outcomes and the assessment criteria.
- To understand the marking scheme, please refer marking criteria.

Marking Criteria

Learning Outcome	Task	Assessment Marking Criteria	Marks
LO1	1.1	Comparing features of large organisations from different sectors of the economy	20
	1.2	Identifying the objectives of large organisations and describing the importance of these objectives	15
	1.3	Explaining how employee relations can impact on the success of a large organisation	15
LO2	2.1	Explaining the impact of internal factors on a large organisation	15
	2.2	Explaining the impact of external factors on a large organisation	20
	2.3	Describing accounting ratios and outlining the use or limitation of ratio analysis	15

The minimum marks required to pass this assignment is 40%